FLIZOW · INTERNAL TEAM HANDBOOK

Capacity & Booking Walkthrough

How Flizow keeps designers from getting double-booked across calendars, HubStaff, and AM-led assignments — and how to use it day-to-day.

Audience. Account managers. You're the ones running the booking flow day-to-day — this walks through what you do, what happens on the designer's side after you assign, and what the ops manager sees when they rebalance.
Read time. ~10 minutes.
Reference scope. The full capacity story end-to-end — from member caps to per-card slot weights to the team-wide heatmap.

Why this exists

Before this system, two account managers could each schedule Sarah for full-day work on the same day. One was looking at Google Calendar, the other at HubStaff. Neither saw the other's bookings until Sarah pushed back. The double-booking problem was structural: there was no shared source of truth for "how booked is this person right now."

Flizow's capacity model fixes that. Every team member gets a daily cap. Every kanban card carries a slot weight that counts against the assignee's cap on its due date. Anyone scheduling work sees, before they confirm, who has room and who doesn't.

> **THE ONE RULE**
>
> When a card lands on a member's queue with a due date, its slot weight gets added to that member's load on that day. If load goes past the soft cap, the system warns. Past the max cap, the system pushes back harder. Same math everywhere — the card modal, My Schedule, the Team Capacity heatmap all read from one source.

The vocabulary

Slot

A unit of work weight. One slot ≈ one chunk of focused effort. A short copy review is 1 slot; a full page design might be 4 slots. The designer is the expert here — AMs can guess, but the assignee confirms.

Soft cap

The target daily load. Default **6 slots**. Below this, the member is comfortable. At or below the soft cap, the cell renders `green`.

Max cap

The ceiling. Default **8 slots**. Between soft and max is the "stretch zone" — visible nudge, no pop-up. Past max is over- capacity territory.

Zones

Zone	Range	Meaning
Green	`load ≤ soft cap`	Under target. Quiet state.
Amber	`soft < load ≤ max`	Stretch zone. The eye picks it up; the system doesn't speak up.
Red	`load > max`	Over the max. Booking flow surfaces a warning.

Setting up — caps per member

The ops manager (or any owner-tier account) sets each team member's caps once. After that, defaults apply unless explicitly overridden.

1. Open **Account & Settings** → **Members** tab.
2. For any member, fill the **Soft** and **Max** fields next to their name.
3. Leave them blank to use the defaults (6 / 8). The system reads defaults at runtime — you won't see "6 / 8" stamped into the field, the math just falls back to it.

> Caps are **per-day**, not per-week. A member can take on more total load across a week than their cap times five — they just can't pile it all into one day.

The booking flow — three perspectives

Booking a piece of work touches three roles. Each one sees a different slice of the same data.

ACCOUNT MANAGER

Creating the work

You're an AM. A client just signed off on a new asset. You go to their service board and add a card.

1. **Open the card modal** after creating the card. You'll see a meta-table with Status, Priority, Assignees, Effort, Due date, Start date, and Labels.
2. **Pick the assignee.** The picker shows every team member with a small **load badge** next to their name — e.g. `3/6` means three slots already booked on the due date you selected, against a soft cap of six. Green means room, red means full.
3. **Set effort (slots).** The Effort row has a number input and a status pill. As an AM, you can guess via the t-shirt picker (S = 1, M = 2, L = 4, XL = 8). The slot value defaults to "Estimated" until the assignee confirms it.
4. **Pick the due date.** If your selection would push the assignee past their max cap, a banner appears above the meta-table. It names the conflict and offers a one-click **"Switch to <next available date>"** action that finds the next weekday where the load + your card's slots is at or below the soft cap.

You don't have to take the suggestion. The warning is a soft block, not a hard one. If the work genuinely has to land on Friday even though Sarah is at 9/8, you can save it that way and walk over to Sarah.

WHAT THE DESIGNER SEES

Their week, after you assign

The card you just assigned lands on the designer's **Overview** page. Two surfaces there matter:

My Tasks

Every open task assigned to them, urgency-down: overdue first, then blocked, then due today, then upcoming, then undated. Not just urgent items — the whole pile. So when you assign something three weeks out, it's still visible to them at the bottom of the list.

My Schedule

A 10-weekday strip (Mon–Fri this week + Mon–Fri next week) showing their cards bucketed by due date. Each day has a load badge in the column header (e.g. `4/6`) tinted by zone. They can see at a glance which day you just dropped onto.

Next to each load badge is a **... button**. They can click it to set a custom cap for one day — for PTO, training half-days, or any one-off where the standing 6/8 doesn't fit. Days with custom caps get a dotted underline. If a designer sets cap = 0 for a day, your booking flow on that day will read them as full.

Confirming your effort guess

The Effort row on the card shows the slot value you set, with a status pill that says *Estimated*. The designer can change the number if your guess is off, then click the pill to flip it to *Confirmed*. Their number is now the authoritative weight; your guess was a starting point. Important to know, because a card you booked at 2 slots might quietly become 4 once they confirm — their day's load math updates accordingly.

WHAT THE OPS MANAGER SEES

The team-wide rebalancing view

On Monday morning, the ops manager opens **Ops → Team Capacity**. They see the workspace-wide grid: rows are team members, columns are the next 10 weekdays. Each cell shows `load/soft` tinted by zone. A typical scan tells them, for example:

- Sarah is buried Tuesday and Wednesday (both red).
- Marcus has a quiet Thursday (1/6 green).

- Aaliyah is consistently amber — stretching but not over.

They click a red cell. A modal opens listing the tasks stacked on Sarah on that day — *including the one you just assigned*. Each row deep-links into the card modal so the ops manager can open it and act on it.

To rebalance, they'll typically:

- Change the assignee to someone with room (shift Sarah's overflow to Marcus). The assignee picker's load badges show who's free.
- Move the due date to a later day. Same capacity warning fires if their new date isn't actually open either.
- Lower the slot weight if the task is genuinely smaller than whoever booked it estimated.

What this means for you as an AM: **the ops manager can move your bookings without asking**. The capacity model treats rebalancing as an explicit operation, not a permissions question. If you've assigned someone a card and you find it on a different day or different person two hours later, the heatmap probably flagged it as over-capacity. The card itself is unchanged in scope — just the schedule.

Edge cases & rules

Multi-owner cards

A card can have a primary assignee plus secondary owners. Only the primary's capacity is touched — secondaries are participants, not capacity holders. The mental model: one person owns each task. If two designers are sharing a job, the AM splits it into two cards.

Done cards

Tasks in the **Done** column don't count toward anyone's load anymore. Finishing work creates breathing room automatically.

Archived cards

Same: archived tasks drop out of every load count. Archive is a soft hide; the data isn't destroyed, but the math ignores it.

Per-day cap overrides

Override a member's cap for a specific day from My Schedule → … button. The override only applies to that day; the next day goes back to the standing cap. Overrides survive across page reloads and Firestore syncs.

Suggestion search window

The "Switch to next available date" finder walks forward up to 14 weekdays, skipping weekends. If nothing in that window has room, the system stops suggesting rather than guessing.

Quick reference

Defaults

Setting	Default	Where to change
Soft cap (per member)	`6 slots`	Account settings → Members tab
Max cap (per member)	`8 slots`	Account settings → Members tab
Slot weight (per task)	`1 slot`	Card modal → Effort row
Slot status	`Estimated`	Card modal → Effort pill
Per-day cap override	none	Overview → My Schedule → … button on a day
Search window for suggestions	14 `weekdays`	Hard-coded; not user-facing

Where each surface lives

Surface	Page	What it shows
Per-card slot editor	Card modal — Effort row	This card's weight + status
Assignee picker with load	Card modal — Assignees row	Each member's load on the due date
Capacity warning banner	Card modal — above meta-table	Fires when assignment goes red
My Schedule	Overview — Block 4	Your 10 weekdays + per-day load
Per-day cap override popover	Overview — My Schedule day header	Custom soft/max for one day
Team Capacity heatmap	Ops — Team Capacity tab	All members × 10 weekdays

The math

THREE PURE FUNCTIONS

All capacity decisions read from these three helpers. If the math looks wrong somewhere, fix it here, not at the call site.

- **loadFor**(member, date) — sums slot weights of every open card where the member is the primary assignee and dueDate matches.
- **effectiveCapFor**(member, date) — resolves the cap pair via per-day override → standing cap → defaults.
- **zoneFor**(load, caps) — returns `green` / `amber` / `red`.

If something's off

If a card's slot weight feels wrong — that's the assignee's call. AMs can guess, but the designer/operator owns the number. Click the Effort pill on the card; it flips between Estimated and Confirmed.

If a member's standing cap feels wrong — that's a one-off conversation with the ops manager. Caps live in Account settings → Members. If someone's load is consistently over despite reasonable effort estimates, the cap might genuinely need to go up; if they're perpetually under, it might need to come down.

If a specific day is wrong — that's a per-day override. From My Schedule, click the … on that day's column header and dial in a custom cap. Reset the override to fall back to your standing cap.

Document version 1 — first draft. Update as the capacity model evolves.